Text 1

快时尚的代价与消费者责任

第 1 段

In the 2006 film version of The Devil Wears Prada, Miranda Priestly, played by Meryl Streep, scolds her unattractive assistant for imagining that high fashion doesn't affect her. Priestly explains how the deep blue color of the assistant's sweater descended over the years from fashion shows to department stores and to the bargain bin in which the poor girl doubtless found her garment.

在 2006 年电影版《穿普拉达的女王》中，梅丽尔 · 斯特里普饰演的米兰达 · 普里斯特利责骂她那位不出众的助理，因为助理以为高级时尚与自己无关。普里斯特利解释说，助理毛衣的深蓝色，是如何经过多年，从时装秀传到百货商店，再传到廉价商品筐里的；那个可怜的姑娘无疑就是在那里找到这件衣服的。

第 2 段

This top-down conception of the fashion business couldn't be more out of date or at odds with the feverish world described in Overdressed, Elizabeth Cline's three-year indictment of "fast fashion". In the last decade or so, advances in technology have allowed mass-market labels such as Zara, H&M, and Uniqlo to react to trends more quickly and anticipate demand more precisely. Quicker turnarounds mean less wasted inventory, more frequent releases, and more profit. These labels encourage style-conscious consumers to see clothes as disposable — meant to last only a wash or two, although they don't advertise that — and to renew their wardrobe every few weeks. By offering on-trend items at dirt-cheap prices, Cline argues, these brands have hijacked fashion cycles, shaking an industry long accustomed to a seasonal pace.

这种自上而下理解时尚业的观念，已经陈旧到了极点，也与伊丽莎白 · 克莱因在《过度着装》中描述的狂热世界完全不符；这本书是她用三年时间写成的对 ' 快时尚 ' 的控诉。过去十来年，技术进步使 Zara、H&M 和优衣库等大众品牌能够更快地回应潮流，更准确地预测需求。更快的周转意味着更少的库存浪费、更频繁的新品发布和更多利润。这些品牌鼓励注重时尚的消费者把衣服看成一次性用品 —— 虽然它们不宣传这一点，但这些衣服本就只打算撑过一两次洗涤 —— 并每隔几周就更新衣橱。克莱因认为，这些品牌以极其便宜的价格提供符合潮流的商品，已经夺取了对时尚周期的控制权，撼动了一个长期习惯按季节节奏运转的行业。

第 3 段

The victims of this revolution, of course, are not limited to designers. For H&M to offer a $5.95 knit miniskirt in all its 2,300-plus stores around the world, it must rely on low-wage overseas labor, order in volumes that strain natural resources, and use massive amounts of harmful chemicals.

当然，这场革命的受害者不只是设计师。H&M 若要在全球 2300 多家门店中都提供一条售价 5.95 美元的针织迷你裙，就必须依靠海外低工资劳动力，以会给自然资源造成压力的规模订货，并使用大量有害化学物质。

第 4 段

Overdressed is the fashion world's answer to consumer-activist bestsellers like Michael Pollan's The Omnivore's Dilemma. "Mass-produced clothing, like fast food, fills a hunger and need, yet is non-durable and wasteful," Cline argues. Americans, she finds, buy roughly 20 billion garments a year — about 64 items per person — and no matter how much they give away, this excess leads to waste.

《过度着装》是时尚界对迈克尔·波伦的《杂食者的困境》这类消费者权益倡导畅销书的回应。克莱因认为：'大批量生产的衣服，就像快餐一样，满足一种欲望和需求，却不耐用而且浪费。'她发现，美国人每年购买约 200 亿件服装 —— 人均约 64 件 —— 无论他们捐赠出去多少，这种过量消费都会造成浪费。

第 5 段

Towards the end of Overdressed, Cline introduced her ideal, a Brooklyn woman named Sarah Kate Beaumont, who since 2008 has made all of her own clothes — and beautifully. But as Cline is the first to note, it took Beaumont decades to perfect her craft; her example can't be knocked off.

在《过度着装》接近结尾处，克莱因介绍了她心目中的理想人物：一位名叫萨拉·凯特·博蒙特的布鲁克林女性。从 2008 年起，博蒙特就自己制作全部衣服，而且做得很漂亮。但正如克莱因自己首先指出的那样，博蒙特花了几十年才把手艺磨炼好；她的榜样不能被轻易复制。

第 6 段

Though several fast-fashion companies have made efforts to curb their impact on labor and the environment — including H&M, with its green Conscious Collection line — Cline believes lasting change can only be effected by the customer. She exhibits the idealism common to many advocates of sustainability, be it in food or in energy. Vanity is a constant; people will only start shopping more sustainably when they can't afford not to.

虽然几家快时尚公司已努力减少对劳工和环境的影响，包括推出绿色'环保自觉系列'的 H&M，但克莱因相信，持久变化只能由消费者促成。她表现出许多可持续发展倡导者共有的理想主义，无论这些倡导者关注的是食品还是能源。虚荣心始终存在；只有当人们承担不起继续以不可持续方式购物的代价时，他们才会开始以更可持续的方式购物。

阅读分析

文章借书评讨论快时尚的生产和消费逻辑，以及对劳工、资源和环境的代价。作者认可问题的严重性，但对仅靠消费者理想主义实现改变持保留态度。

直译提示

首段电影例子代表旧的自上而下模式，第 2 段立即转折；末句 can't afford not to 中 not to 省略 shop more sustainably，意为'无法承受不这样做的代价'。

Text 2

网络广告与默认隐私设置

第 1 段

An old saying has it that half of all advertising budgets are wasted — the trouble is, no one knows which half. In the internet age, at least in theory, this fraction can be much reduced. By watching what people search for, click on and say online, companies can aim “behavioural” ads at those most likely to buy.

有句老话说，全部广告预算中有一半都被浪费了 —— 问题是，没有人知道是哪一半。在互联网时代，至少在理论上，这一比例可以大幅降低。通过观察人们在网上搜索什么、点击什么、说些什么，企业可以把 ‘ 行为定向 ’ 广告投向那些最可能购买的人。

第 2 段

In the past couple of weeks a quarrel has illustrated the value to advertisers of such fine-grained information: Should advertisers assume that people are happy to be tracked and sent behavioural ads? Or should they have explicit permission?

过去几周的一场争论，说明了这种细致入微的信息对广告商的价值：广告商是否应该假定，人们乐意被跟踪并接收行为定向广告？还是说，广告商应该先获得明确许可？

第 3 段

In December 2010 America’s Federal Trade Commission (FTC) proposed adding a “do not track” (DNT) option to internet browsers, so that users could tell advertisers that they did not want to be followed. Microsoft’s Internet Explorer and Apple’s Safari both offer DNT; Google’s Chrome is due to do so this year. In February the FTC and the Digital Advertising Alliance (DAA) agreed that the industry would get cracking on responding to DNT requests.

2010 年 12 月，美国联邦贸易委员会（FTC）提议在互联网浏览器中加入 ‘ 请勿跟踪 ’（DNT）选项，让用户能够告诉广告商，自己不希望被追踪。微软的 Internet Explorer 和苹果的 Safari 都提供 DNT 功能；谷歌的 Chrome 预计于当年提供这一功能。二月，FTC 与数字广告联盟（DAA）达成一致，广告业将开始认真处理 DNT 请求。

第 4 段

On May 31st Microsoft set off the row. It said that Internet Explorer 10, the version due to appear with Windows 8, would have DNT as a default.

5 月 31 日，微软引发了这场争论。它表示，计划与 Windows 8 一同推出的 Internet Explorer 10，将把 DNT 设为默认选项。

第 5 段

Advertisers are horrified. Human nature being what it is, most people stick with default settings. Few switch DNT on now, but if tracking is off it will stay off. Bob Liodice, the chief executive of the Association of National Advertisers, says consumers will be worse off if the industry cannot collect information about their preferences. People will not get fewer ads, he says. “They’ll get less meaningful, less targeted ads.”

广告商惊恐不已。人性就是如此，大多数人会沿用默认设置。如今，很少有人主动打开 DNT；但如果跟踪功能默认关闭，它就会一直保持关闭。美国全国广告商协会首席执行官鲍勃 · 利奥迪斯说，如果广告业无法收集消费者偏好的信息，消费者的处境反而会更差。他说，人们收到的广告不会更少：‘ 他们会收到更缺乏意义、针对性更弱的广告。’

第 6 段

It is not yet clear how advertisers will respond. Getting a DNT signal does not oblige anyone to stop tracking, although some companies have promised to do so. Unable to tell whether someone really objects to behavioural ads or whether they are sticking with Microsoft’s default, some may ignore a DNT signal and press on anyway.

广告商将如何回应，目前还不清楚。收到 DNT 信号并不使任何人负有停止跟踪的义务，尽管一些公司已承诺这样做。由于无法判断某人是真的反对行为定向广告，还是只是沿用微软的默认设置，一些公司可能会忽视 DNT 信号，照样继续跟踪。

第 7 段

Also unclear is why Microsoft has gone it alone. After all, it has an ad business too, which it says will comply with DNT requests, though it is still working out how. If it is trying to upset Google, which relies almost wholly on advertising, it has chosen an indirect method: there is no guarantee that DNT by default will become the norm. DNT does not seem an obviously huge selling point for windows 8 — though the firm has compared some of its other products favourably with Google’s on that count before. Brendon Lynch, Microsoft’s chief privacy officer, blogged: “We believe consumers should have more control.” Could it really be that simple?

同样不清楚的是，微软为何要独自采取行动。毕竟，它自己也有广告业务，而且它说这项业务会遵守 DNT 请求，尽管仍在研究具体怎么做。如果它是在试图打击几乎完全依靠广告的谷歌，那么它选择了一种间接的方法：没有什么能保证默认启用 DNT 会成为常态。DNT 似乎也并不是 Windows 8 一个明显巨大的卖点，尽管微软此前确实曾在这一点上把自己的其他产品与谷歌产品作有利于自己的比较。微软首席隐私官布伦登 · 林奇在博客中写道：‘ 我们认为消费者应该拥有更多控制权。’事情真的会这么简单吗?

阅读分析

文章围绕默认开启 DNT 引发的争论，呈现广告精准投放、用户选择和企业利益之间的冲突。结尾对微软解释提出疑问，保留了对其动机的怀疑。文中时间均指文章写作时。

直译提示

第 5 段 Human nature being what it is 是独立主格结构；第 7 段 on that count 指隐私控制这一点，不能译成 ‘ 按那个数字计算 ’。

Text 3

从长远尺度看人类的未来

第 1 段

Up until a few decades ago, our visions of the future were largely — though by no means uniformly — glowingly positive. Science and technology would cure all the ills of humanity, leading to lives of fulfilment and opportunity for all.

直到几十年前，我们对未来的想象在很大程度上 —— 尽管绝非一概如此 —— 都充满光明和乐观。科学技术将治愈人类的一切弊病，使所有人过上充实而充满机会的生活。

第 2 段

Now utopia has grown unfashionable, as we have gained a deeper appreciation of the range of threats facing us, from asteroid strike to epidemic flu and to climate change. You might even be tempted to assume that humanity has little future to look forward to.

如今，乌托邦已经不再时兴，因为我们更加深刻地认识到自己面临的一系列威胁，从小行星撞击到流感大流行，再到气候变化。你甚至可能因此以为，人类已没有什么值得期待的未来。

第 3 段

But such gloominess is misplaced. The fossil record shows that many species have endured for millions of years — so why shouldn't we? Take a broader look at our species' place in the universe, and it becomes clear that we have an excellent chance of surviving for tens, if not hundreds, of thousands of years. Look up Homo sapiens in the "Red List" of threatened species of the International Union for the Conservation of Nature (IUCN) and you will read: "Listed as Least Concern as the species is very widely distributed, adaptable, currently increasing, and there are no major threats resulting in an overall population decline."

但是，这种悲观并不恰当。化石记录显示，许多物种已经延续了数百万年 —— 那为什么我们不能呢？从更广阔的视野看我们这一物种在宇宙中的位置，就会清楚地发现，我们极有可能生存数万年，甚至数十万年。如果你在国际自然保护联盟（IUCN）的濒危物种《红色名录》中查找智人，就会读到：‘列为无危，因为该物种分布非常广泛，适应力强，目前数量正在增长，而且没有会造成总体种群数量下降的重大威胁。’

第 4 段

So what does our deep future hold? A growing number of researchers and organisations are now thinking seriously about that question. For example, the Long Now Foundation has as its flagship project a mechanical clock that is designed to still be marking time thousands of years hence.

那么，我们的遥远未来会是什么样？越来越多的研究者和组织正在认真思考这个问题。例如，长远当下基金会的旗舰项目是一座机械钟，其设计目标是在数千年后仍然能够计时。

第 5 段

Perhaps willfully, it may be easier to think about such lengthy timescales than about the more immediate future. The potential evolution of today's technology, and its social consequences, is dazzlingly complicated, and it's perhaps best left to science fiction writers and futurologists to explore the many possibilities we can envisage. That's one reason why we have launched Arc, a new publication dedicated to the near future.

也许多少带着刻意的选择，思考这样漫长的时间尺度，可能比思考更近的未来还容易。今天技术的潜在演变及其社会后果复杂得令人眼花缭乱，因此，探索我们所能设想的种种可能性，或许最好留给科幻作家和未来学家。这也是我们创办《Arc》这本专注于近期未来的新刊物的原因之一。

第 6 段

But take a longer view and there is a surprising amount that we can say with considerable assurance. As so often, the past holds the key to the future: we have now identified enough of the long-term patterns shaping the history of the planet, and our species, to make evidence-based forecasts about the situations in which our descendants will find themselves.

但是，把目光放得更长远，我们就能以相当大的把握说出多得令人惊讶的事情。正如经常发生的那样，过去掌握着通向未来的钥匙：如今，我们已经识别出足够多的、塑造地球及人类历史的长期模式，因此能够依据证据，对我们的后代将会置身的情境作出预测。

第 7 段

This long perspective makes the pessimistic view of our prospects seem more likely to be a passing fad. To be sure, the future is not all rosy. But we are now knowledgeable enough to reduce many of the risks that threatened the existence of earlier humans, and to improve the lot of those to come.

这种长远视角使关于人类前景的悲观看法更像是一阵短暂的风尚。诚然，未来并非一片玫瑰色。但是，我们现在已掌握足够多的知识，能够减少许多曾威胁早期人类生存的风险，并改善后来者的命运。

阅读分析

作者反对对人类长期未来的过度悲观，通过物种延续和长期历史模式说明谨慎乐观的依据；同时承认未来存在风险，并区分短期技术预测与长期趋势判断。

直译提示

第 3 段 tens, if not hundreds, of thousands of years 意为 ‘ 数万年，甚至可能数十万年 ’；末段 not all rosy 是部分否定，不能译为 ‘ 未来完全没有希望 ’。

Text 4

移民执法中的联邦与州权力

第 1 段

On a five to three vote, the Supreme Court knocked out much of Arizona's immigration law Monday — a modest policy victory for the Obama Administration. But on the more important matter of the Constitution, the decision was an 8-0 defeat for the Administration's effort to upset the balance of power between the federal government and the states.

周一，最高法院以五票对三票的结果否决了亚利桑那州移民法的大部分内容，这对奥巴马政府而言是一次有限的政策胜利。但是，在更重要的宪法问题上，这一决定又以八票对零票的结果，挫败了政府打破联邦政府与各州之间权力平衡的努力。

第 2 段

In Arizona v. United States, the majority overturned three of the four contested provisions of Arizona's controversial plan to have state and local police enforce federal immigration law. The Constitutional principles that Washington alone has the power to "establish a uniform Rule of Naturalization" and that federal laws precede state laws are noncontroversial. Arizona had attempted to fashion state policies that ran parallel to the existing federal ones.

在 ' 亚利桑那州诉美国 ' 一案中，多数法官推翻了亚利桑那州那项有争议的方案中四项受到质疑的条款里的三项；该方案拟让州和地方警察执行联邦移民法。只有华盛顿才有权 ' 制定统一的入籍规则 '，以及联邦法优先于州法，这些宪法原则并无争议。亚利桑那州曾试图制定与现有联邦政策并行的州政策。

第 3 段

Justice Anthony Kennedy, joined by Chief Justice John Roberts and the Court's liberals, ruled that the state flew too close to the federal sun. On the overturned provisions the majority held Congress had deliberately "occupied the field" and Arizona had thus intruded on the federal's privileged powers.

大法官安东尼 · 肯尼迪在首席大法官约翰 · 罗伯茨和法院自由派法官的支持下，裁定该州飞得离 ' 联邦太阳 ' 太近了。对于被推翻的条款，多数法官认为，国会已经有意 ' 占据这一领域 '，因而亚利桑那州侵入了联邦的专属权限。

第 4 段

However, the Justices said that Arizona police would be allowed to verify the legal status of people who come in contact with law enforcement. That's because Congress has always envisioned joint federal-state immigration enforcement and explicitly encourages state officers to share information and cooperate with federal colleagues.

然而，大法官们表示，亚利桑那州警察将获准核实与执法部门接触的人员的合法身份。这是因为，国会一直设想由联邦与州联合执行移民法，并明确鼓励州官员分享信息、与联邦同僚合作。

第 5 段

Two of the three objecting Justices — Samuel Alito and Clarence Thomas — agreed with this Constitutional logic but disagreed about which Arizona rules conflicted with the federal statute. The only major objection came from Justice Antonin Scalia, who offered an even more robust defense of state privileges going back to the Alien and Sedition Acts.

三位持异议的大法官中，有两位 —— 塞缪尔 · 阿利托和克拉伦斯 · 托马斯 —— 赞同这一宪法逻辑，但对于亚利桑那州的哪些规定与联邦法律冲突，存在不同意见。唯一重大的反对意见来自安东宁 · 斯卡利亚大法官；他追溯到《外国人法和惩治叛乱法》，对各州的特权作出了更有力的辩护。

第 6 段

The 8-0 objection to President Obama turns on what Justice Samuel Alito describes in his objection as “a shocking assertion of federal executive power”. The White House argued that Arizona’s laws conflicted with its enforcement priorities, even if state laws complied with federal statutes to the letter. In effect, the White House claimed that it could invalidate any otherwise legitimate state law that it disagrees with.

针对奥巴马总统的八票对零票的反对意见，关键在于塞缪尔 · 阿利托大法官在异议意见中所称的 ‘ 令人震惊的联邦行政权力主张 ’。白宫辩称，亚利桑那州的法律与它的执法优先事项冲突，即使这些州法完全遵守联邦成文法也是如此。实际上，白宫声称，它可以使任何自己不赞同、但在其他方面合法的州法失效。

第 7 段

Some powers do belong exclusively to the federal government, and control of citizenship and the borders is among them. But if Congress wanted to prevent states from using their own resources to check immigration status, it could. It never did so. The Administration was in essence asserting that because it didn’t want to carry out Congress’s immigration wishes, no state should be allowed to do so either. Every Justice rightly rejected this remarkable claim.

某些权力确实专属于联邦政府，管理公民身份与国境就是其中之一。但是，如果国会想阻止各州使用自己的资源核查移民身份，它是可以这样做的；它从未这样做过。奥巴马政府实际上是在宣称，因为它不想执行国会在移民问题上的意愿，所以任何州也都不应获准执行。每一位大法官都正确地驳回了这一非同寻常的主张。

阅读分析

本文是带有鲜明立场的评论：作者把州法部分条款被推翻与联邦行政权扩张受否定分开，肯定后者。阅读时须区分国会制定的联邦法律与行政部门的执法偏好。

直译提示

第 3 段 flew too close to the federal sun 用比喻说明触碰联邦权限；第 6 段 even if 引出让步，to the letter 表示严格遵守，otherwise legitimate 指除行政部门不赞同外原本合法。